

# STAAR Bootcamp: staar-wars

## ★ STAAR Wars — Quick-Start Overview

### Welcome, Commander!

You’ve just downloaded the **STAAR Wars Boot Camp** — a complete, space-themed STAAR prep week that transforms your classroom into STAAR Command and your hallway into a space station. Your students are cadets on a 5-day mission to conquer the STAAR.

### 📦 What’s in This Package

| File                 | What It Is                                                                                         |
|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| LESSON-PLANS.md      | Complete 5-day (Mon–Fri) lesson framework with time blocks, daily themes, and differentiation tips |
| ACTIVITIES.md        | 12 themed activities with full instructions, materials, and time estimates                         |
| DECORATIONS.md       | Step-by-step hallway & classroom transformation guide with materials lists and budget options      |
| STUDENT-MATERIALS.md | Every student-facing handout, badge, certificate, and reward described in detail                   |
| PARENT-LETTER.md     | Ready-to-send letter explaining boot camp week to families                                         |

### 🚀 The Theme at a Glance

- **Setting:** Outer space / STAAR Command space station

- **Students are:** Cadets on a mission
- **Teacher is:** Mission Commander
- **Each day is:** A new mission (Mission 1–5)
- **Completing work earns:** Mission Badges
- **The week builds to:** Launch Day (STAAR test day)
- **Hallway becomes:** A space station corridor
- **Classroom becomes:** STAAR Command Center

 **Week Overview**

| Day       | Mission Name                             | Focus                                                      |
|-----------|------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| Monday    | <b>Mission 1: Launch Prep</b>            | Reading/ELA foundations — main idea, inference, vocabulary |
| Tuesday   | <b>Mission 2: Orbit Check</b>            | Math fundamentals — computation, number sense, equations   |
| Wednesday | <b>Mission 3: Deep Space Exploration</b> | Science & Social Studies review (or continued ELA/Math)    |
| Thursday  | <b>Mission 4: Re-Entry Simulation</b>    | Mixed practice — full STAAR-format review across subjects  |
| Friday    | <b>Mission 5: Countdown to Launch</b>    | Test-taking strategies, confidence building, final review  |

 **How to Run This Week**

## 2 Weeks Before

- ☐ Read through LESSON-PLANS.md completely
- ☐ Order/gather decoration supplies (see DECORATIONS.md)
- ☐ Print student materials (see STUDENT-MATERIALS.md)
- ☐ Send parent letter home (see PARENT-LETTER.md)

## Weekend Before

- ☐ Set up hallway decorations (enlist student helpers or team members!)
- ☐ Set up classroom decorations
- ☐ Organize student materials into daily packets
- ☐ Prep daily playlists (optional but fun)

## Each Morning (Boot Camp Week)

1. Play space-themed music as students enter
2. Deliver the **Mission Briefing** (see teacher scripts in LESSON-PLANS.md)
3. Hand out daily mission packet
4. Run activities from ACTIVITIES.md as needed
5. Award **Mission Badges** at end of day
6. Update the **Launch Sequence Countdown** poster

## Friday Afternoon

- Award **Mission Complete** certificates
- Take a group photo in front of your decorations
- Remind students: “You’ve trained for this. You’re STAAR-ready!”

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## Customization Tips

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- **Pick your grade level & subject** — lesson plans are designed as frameworks you fill with your specific TEKS
- **Scale up or down** — use all 5 days or pick your favorite 3

- **Team up** — each teacher on the grade level can be a different “space station” with different subject missions
  - **Mix with your own materials** — drop your existing review worksheets into the themed framework
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## Pro Tips

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1. **Commit to the bit.** Wear a NASA shirt. Call yourself Commander. The more you lean in, the more students buy in.
  2. **Start decorations early.** Friday before boot camp week is ideal. Recruit parent volunteers or student helpers.
  3. **The badges matter.** Students will work harder for a sticker on a badge card than for a grade. Trust the system.
  4. **Use the playlist.** Music transforms the energy in the room.
  5. **Take photos!** Parents love seeing the themed classroom. Post on your class page/Remind app.
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*You’ve got this, Commander. Let’s make STAAR prep the best week of the year. 🚀*

## STAAR Wars — 5-Day Lesson Plans

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***Mission Commander’s Guide to Boot Camp Week*** Adapt these plans to your grade level (3rd–8th) and tested subjects. The framework is flexible — plug in your specific TEKS-aligned content.

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## Daily Schedule Template

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| Time Block       | Duration | Activity                                   |
|------------------|----------|--------------------------------------------|
| Mission Briefing | 10 min   | Themed warm-up, daily overview, motivation |
| Training Block 1 | 45 min   | Core instruction / guided review           |
| Fuel Break       | 5 min    | Brain break / transition                   |
| Training Block 2 | 40 min   | Practice / application                     |
| Mission Debrief  | 10 min   | Review key takeaways, award badges         |

*Adjust times to your bell schedule. This template assumes ~110 minutes of instructional time per subject block.*

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## MONDAY — Mission 1: Launch Prep

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**Theme:** “Before we launch, every system must be checked. Today we verify our foundational knowledge.”

**Focus:** Reading/ELA Foundations (or your primary tested subject)

### Mission Briefing (10 min)

**Teacher Script:** > “Good morning, Cadets! Welcome to STAAR Command. I’m your Mission Commander, and this week, you’re part of the most elite training program in the galaxy. Every astronaut trains before a launch — and that’s exactly what we’re doing. STAAR is our launch day, and by Friday, you’ll be fully mission-ready. Today’s mission: Launch Prep. We’re checking every system — every skill — to make sure we’re ready for liftoff. Let’s go!”

**Activities:** - Hand out **Cadet ID badges** (see STUDENT-MATERIALS.md) - Show the **Launch Sequence Countdown** poster — “5 days to launch!” - Quick preview of the week’s missions

## Training Block 1: Guided Review (45 min)

**Reading/ELA Focus Areas (adapt to your grade):** - **3rd–5th:** Main idea & supporting details, making inferences, author’s purpose, vocabulary in context - **6th–8th:** Summarizing, analyzing literary elements, author’s craft, textual evidence

**Structure:** 1. **(10 min) “Systems Check” Warm-Up** — 5 quick multiple-choice questions projected on board, students answer on whiteboards or scrap paper. Review answers together. Frame each question as a “system” being checked (Navigation System = main idea, Communication System = vocabulary, etc.)

2. **(20 min) “Star Map” Guided Practice** — Teacher models a STAAR-format passage and question set. Think-aloud strategy: “Here’s how a trained astronaut reads this passage...” Walk through annotation strategies, elimination techniques, and evidence-finding.

3. **(15 min) “Co-Pilot Practice”** — Students pair up. Each pair gets a short passage with 3-4 questions. Partner A reads aloud, Partner B annotates. Then they answer questions together, discussing their thinking. Switch roles for a second passage.

## Fuel Break (5 min)

- Space-themed brain break: “Asteroid Dodge” — students stand, teacher calls out commands (jump left, duck right, spin) to dodge “asteroids.” Quick physical reset.

## Training Block 2: Independent Practice (40 min)

**“Mission 1 Packet”** - STAAR-format passage(s) with 8-12 multiple choice and/or open-ended questions - Students work independently — this simulates actual test conditions - Frame it: “This is your first solo mission. Show me what you’ve got, Cadets.” - Early finishers: “Bonus Transmission” — an extra challenge passage or writing prompt

**Differentiation:** - **Struggling students:** Provide a “Mission Support” version with vocabulary pre-taught and shorter passages. Pair with a “Senior Cadet” (stronger reader) if needed. - **Advanced students:** Include a “Commander’s Challenge” — an above-grade-level passage or an analytical writing prompt. - **ELL students:** Provide bilingual glossary for key terms. Allow use of approved dictionaries per STAAR accommodation guidelines.

## Mission Debrief (10 min)

- Review 2-3 most-missed questions from the packet
- **Key Strategy of the Day:** Write on board in “Space Log” format — e.g., “Space Log Entry 1: Always go back to the text for evidence. Never trust your memory in zero gravity.”
- Award **Mission 1 Badges** to students who completed the packet
- Update countdown poster: “4 days to launch!”

## Materials Needed:

- ☐ Cadet ID badges (printed)
  - ☐ Launch Sequence Countdown poster
  - ☐ Whiteboards or scrap paper + markers
  - ☐ Mission 1 passage/question packet (teacher provides — use released STAAR questions or your own)
  - ☐ Mission 1 Badges (stickers or stamps on badge card)
  - ☐ “Bonus Transmission” extra challenge (1-2 pages)
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## 🌟 TUESDAY — Mission 2: Orbit Check

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**Theme:** “We’ve cleared the atmosphere. Now we need to verify our calculations are solid. Math keeps us in orbit.”

**Focus:** Mathematics

## Mission Briefing (10 min)

**Teacher Script:** > “Cadets! Yesterday you crushed Launch Prep. Mission 1: complete. Today we’re in orbit, and you know what keeps a spacecraft in orbit? MATH. Precise calculations. Today’s mission is Orbit Check — we’re making sure our math skills are locked in tight. One wrong calculation and we drift into the void. No pressure! Let’s go, Cadets!”

**Activities:** - Update the **Mission Progress Board** (who earned Mission 1 badges?) -  
 Play a 2-minute space fact video or show an image from NASA's website as a hook -  
 Preview today's math focus areas

### Training Block 1: Guided Review (45 min)

**Math Focus Areas (adapt to your grade):** - **3rd–4th:** Multiplication/division facts, fractions, measurement, word problems - **5th–6th:** Decimals, ratios, geometry basics, data analysis, expressions - **7th–8th:** Proportional relationships, equations/inequalities, statistics, financial literacy

**Structure:** 1. **(10 min) “Navigation Calculations” Warm-Up** — 5 computation problems displayed. Students solve on whiteboards. Frame: “If you get this wrong, the ship goes off course! Calculate carefully!” Review strategies for each.

2. **(20 min) “Orbit Plotting” Guided Practice** — Teacher models 3-4 STAAR-format word problems. Emphasize: reading the problem twice, identifying what's being asked, showing work, checking reasonableness. Use space contexts where possible: “The space station orbits Earth every 90 minutes. If the crew has been aboard for 3 days...”
3. **(15 min) “Mission Control Pairs”** — Partners work through a set of 6 problems. One is “Mission Control” (checks work, asks questions), the other is the “Pilot” (solves). Switch roles after 3 problems.

### Fuel Break (5 min)

- “Zero Gravity Freeze Dance” — play space-themed music, students dance. When music stops, freeze in a “floating in space” pose. Silly but effective energy reset.

### Training Block 2: Independent Practice (40 min)

**“Mission 2 Packet”** - 15-20 STAAR-format math problems covering major reporting categories - Include a mix: multiple choice, griddable (where applicable), and multi-step problems - Frame: “Orbit Check simulation. Every calculation matters.”

**Differentiation:** - **Struggling students:** “Mission Support” version with fewer problems, worked examples at the top, and a formula/reference sheet - **Advanced students:** “Commander's Challenge” — problems requiring multi-step reasoning or real-



world application - **ELL students:** Simplified language in word problems; key math vocabulary glossary

### Mission Debrief (10 min)

- Review 2-3 tricky problems as a class
- **Key Strategy of the Day:** “Space Log Entry 2: Always show your work. In space, we check every calculation twice.”
- Award **Mission 2 Badges**
- Countdown: “3 days to launch!”

### Materials Needed:

- ☐ Whiteboards + markers
- ☐ Mission 2 math packet (teacher provides)
- ☐ Formula/reference sheet (for Mission Support version)
- ☐ Mission 2 Badges
- ☐ Calculator (if allowed for your grade level)
- ☐ Space-themed music playlist

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## **WEDNESDAY — Mission 3: Deep Space Exploration**

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**Theme:** “We’ve gone deeper into space than ever before. Time to explore the unknown — science and the world around us.”

**Focus:** Science & Social Studies (or your secondary tested subjects). If your students only test in ELA & Math, use this day for cross-curricular review or deeper dives into weak areas.

### Mission Briefing (10 min)

**Teacher Script:** > “Cadets, we are now in DEEP SPACE. The easy part is over. Today’s mission takes us into uncharted territory — we’re exploring science and the world around us. Every great astronaut is also a scientist and a historian. Today, we explore. Let’s see what’s out there!”

## Training Block 1: Science Review (45 min)

**Science Focus Areas (adapt to grade):** - **5th:** Matter & energy, force/motion, Earth & space, organisms & environments - **8th:** Force/motion/energy, matter, Earth & space, organisms/environments, reporting categories

**Structure:** 1. **(10 min) “Scan the Galaxy” Quick Review** — 5 science questions, rapid-fire on whiteboards 2. **(20 min) “Alien Specimens” Lab-Style Review** — Set up 4-5 stations around the room, each with a different science concept. Students rotate in groups (5 min each), answering 2-3 questions per station. Frame: “Each station is a different planet with alien specimens to analyze.” 3. **(15 min) “Transmission from Earth” Class Discussion** — Teacher-led review of most commonly tested science concepts. Use a quick sort activity: students categorize vocabulary terms into correct science domains.

### Fuel Break (5 min)

- “Alien Dance-Off” — students create their best alien dance move. Vote on the most creative. Quick, silly, resets energy.

## Training Block 2: Social Studies Review (40 min)

**Social Studies Focus Areas (adapt to grade):** - **8th:** U.S. History (major eras, key figures, government, geography, economics, citizenship)

**Structure:** 1. **(15 min) “History of the Galaxy” Timeline Activity** — Create a collaborative class timeline of key events. Each student gets a card with an event; they must place themselves in chronological order. Discuss connections. 2. **(25 min) “Mission 3 Packet”** — Mixed science/social studies STAAR-format questions

**Differentiation:** - **Struggling students:** Concept cards with visuals and simplified definitions - **Advanced students:** Analysis questions — “Compare and contrast” or “What would have happened if...” - **ELL students:** Visual-heavy materials, bilingual key terms

### Mission Debrief (10 min)

- **Space Log Entry 3:** “The universe is full of connections. Science explains HOW things work. History explains WHY things happened. Look for patterns.”
- Award **Mission 3 Badges**
- Countdown: “2 days to launch!”
- 🎉 **Midweek morale boost:** Hand out small treats or play a quick reward game (see ACTIVITIES.md — “Asteroid Field” review game)

### Materials Needed:

- ☐ Station materials (printed question sets, any manipulatives)
- ☐ Timeline cards (events on index cards)
- ☐ Mission 3 mixed packet
- ☐ Concept vocabulary cards with visuals
- ☐ Midweek treats (optional)
- ☐ Mission 3 Badges

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## 🌟 THURSDAY — Mission 4: Re-Entry Simulation

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**Theme:** “Re-entry is the most dangerous part of any space mission. It requires focus, precision, and calm under pressure. Today we simulate the real thing.”

**Focus:** Full STAAR-Format Mixed Practice (all subjects)

### Mission Briefing (10 min)

**Teacher Script:** > “Cadets. Listen up. Today is Re-Entry Simulation. This is the closest thing to the real mission you’ll experience before launch day. Re-entry is when astronauts have to be most focused — one wrong move and things go sideways. Today, I need your absolute best. You’re going to see questions from every subject, just like the real STAAR. Treat this like the real deal. Silence. Focus. You’ve trained for this.”

### Training Block 1: Timed Practice Simulation (45 min)

**“Re-Entry Simulation Exam”** - Create a mini STAAR-format test (20-30 questions) covering all tested subjects - Timed — give students a set amount of time (match

approximate STAAR pacing) - Test-like conditions: silent, independent work, no phones, desks separated - Frame: “This is your re-entry simulation. Mission Control is watching.”

### Fuel Break (5 min)

- Quiet break — stretching only. Maintain the serious tone of “simulation day.”

### Training Block 2: Review & Strategy (40 min)

**“Post-Simulation Analysis”** 1. **(15 min)** Students self-grade or teacher reviews answers together 2. **(10 min)** Students identify their “weak zones” — which types of questions gave them trouble? 3. **(15 min)** Small group review — group students by weak area. Teacher circulates and provides targeted mini-lessons. Use “Senior Cadets” (students who scored high) as peer tutors.

**Differentiation:** - Group students by need for the small group portion - Provide targeted review materials for each group - Students who aced the simulation become “Mission Specialists” who help others

### Mission Debrief (10 min)

- **Space Log Entry 4:** “Re-entry is hard. But you survived the simulation. The real mission will feel just like this — and now you know what to expect.”
- Award **Mission 4 Badges**
- Countdown: “1 day to launch! Tomorrow is our final prep day.”
- Motivational moment: Share a story about an astronaut who overcame failure (Mae Jemison, Chris Hadfield, etc.)

### Materials Needed:

- ☐ Mini STAAR-format practice test (20-30 questions, mixed subjects)
  - ☐ Answer key / answer document
  - ☐ Scrap paper
  - ☐ Timer
  - ☐ Targeted review materials for small groups
  - ☐ Mission 4 Badges
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## **FRIDAY — Mission 5: Countdown to Launch**

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**Theme:** “Final preparations. Confidence. Calm. You are ready.”

**Focus:** Test-Taking Strategies, Confidence Building, Light Review

### **Mission Briefing (10 min)**

**Teacher Script:** > “Cadets. This is it. Final day of training. You have worked SO hard this week. You’ve completed four missions. You’ve proven you have the skills. Today isn’t about cramming — today is about CONFIDENCE. Today we sharpen our strategies, steady our nerves, and prepare for launch. When you walk into that testing room, you will be the most prepared cadets in the galaxy. I believe in you. Let’s finish this.”

### **Training Block 1: Strategy Review (45 min)**

#### **“Mission Commander’s Strategy Session”**

1. **(15 min) “Top 10 STAAR Survival Strategies”** — Teacher-led review of the most important test-taking strategies:
  - Read the question FIRST, then the passage (for reading)
  - Eliminate two wrong answers before guessing
  - Show all work in math (even if you can do it in your head)
  - Budget your time — don’t spend 10 minutes on one question
  - Go back and check answers if you finish early
  - Trust your first instinct (but verify with evidence)
  - For open-ended responses: restate the question, give evidence, explain
  - Read ALL answer choices before selecting
  - Skip hard questions and come back
  - Stay calm — if you feel stuck, take 3 deep breaths
2. **(15 min) “Error Analysis: Common Traps”** — Show examples of common STAAR trick questions and how to avoid them. Students practice identifying “trap” answer choices.

3. **(15 min) “Rapid Fire Review Game”** — Quick, fun, low-stakes review game (see ACTIVITIES.md — “Warp Speed Challenge”). Focus on high-frequency tested concepts.

### Fuel Break (5 min)

- “Meditation in Space” — 2 minutes of quiet breathing/mindfulness. “Astronauts train their minds, not just their skills.”

### Training Block 2: Confidence & Celebration (40 min)

1. **(10 min) “Letters to Myself”** — Students write a short letter to themselves: “What I’m proud of learning this week” and “What I’m going to remember on test day.” They seal it in an envelope. Teacher can hand these back before the actual STAAR test.
2. **(10 min) “Mission Complete” Certificate Ceremony** — Call each student up, shake their hand, award their **Mission Complete Certificate**. Make it a moment. Take photos.
3. **(10 min) “Commander’s Final Transmission”** — Teacher gives a final pep talk. Read the motivational quote poster aloud. Tell students specifically what you’ve seen them accomplish this week.
4. **(10 min) Celebration** — Play the space playlist, let students sign each other’s “Cadet Yearbook” page (a fun printable where students can write encouraging messages to each other). Hand out small treats if allowed.

### Mission Debrief — Final Entry (10 min)

- **Space Log Entry 5:** “Training complete. All systems go. You are STAAR-ready. Launch when ready.”
- All 5 **Mission Badges** earned = full badge card complete
- Countdown: “LAUNCH DAY IS NEXT! 🚀 ”
- Final cheer: “3... 2... 1... We are STAAR READY!” (students count down together)

### Materials Needed:

- ☐ “Top 10 Strategies” anchor chart or slides

- ☐ Example “trap” questions
  - ☐ Envelopes for student letters
  - ☐ Mission Complete Certificates (printed)
  - ☐ “Cadet Yearbook” page (printed)
  - ☐ Treats (optional)
  - ☐ Space playlist
  - ☐ Camera for photos
  - ☐ Mission 5 Badges
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## Week-at-a-Glance Planning Checklist

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### Print Before Monday:

- ☐ Cadet ID badges (1 per student)
- ☐ Mission Badge cards (1 per student)
- ☐ Mission 1–5 packets (1 per student per day)
- ☐ Bonus Transmission extras (10-15 copies)
- ☐ Mission Complete Certificates (1 per student)
- ☐ Launch Sequence Countdown poster (1)
- ☐ Cadet Yearbook page (1 per student, for Friday)
- ☐ Door sign: “STAAR Command Center”

### Gather Before Monday:

- ☐ Whiteboards + dry erase markers (or scrap paper)
- ☐ Stickers/stamps for badges
- ☐ Treats for midweek and Friday (optional)
- ☐ Timer for Thursday simulation
- ☐ Envelopes for Friday letters
- ☐ Decoration supplies (see DECORATIONS.md)

### Prep Your Content:

- ☐ Select/create STAAR-format passages and questions for each day's packet
  - ☐ Use released STAAR tests from TEA (available at [tea.texas.gov](http://tea.texas.gov))
  - ☐ Align questions to your specific grade-level TEKS
  - ☐ Create answer keys for each packet
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## Daily Playlist Suggestions

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### Monday — Launch Energy

- “Rocket Man” — Elton John
- “Space Oddity” — David Bowie
- “Fly Me to the Moon” — Frank Sinatra
- “Counting Stars” — OneRepublic
- “Shoot for the Stars” — motivational instrumental

### Tuesday — Focus & Calculation

- Lo-fi space beats (search “space lo-fi” on YouTube/Spotify)
- Interstellar soundtrack — Hans Zimmer
- “The Planets” — Gustav Holst (orchestral, great for focus)

### Wednesday — Exploration & Discovery

- “A Whole New World” — Aladdin (exploration vibes)
- “Explorer” — instrumental
- National Geographic-style adventure music

### Thursday — Intensity & Focus

- Epic orchestral music (search “epic focus music”)
- “Time” — Hans Zimmer
- Minimal music — maintain simulation atmosphere

### Friday — Celebration & Confidence



- “We Are the Champions” — Queen
- “Don’t Stop Believin’” — Journey
- “Roar” — Katy Perry
- “Fight Song” — Rachel Platten
- “Happy” — Pharrell Williams
- “Can’t Hold Us” — Macklemore

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May the STAAR be with you, Commander. ★

## ★ STAAR Wars — Themed Activities

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*12 ready-to-run activities for your STAAR Wars Boot Camp week. Mix of individual, partner, and group. Includes 3 review games.*

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### REVIEW GAMES

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#### 1. Asteroid Field (Whole Class Game)

**Type:** Group | **Time:** 20-25 min | **Best for:** Any subject review

**Setup:** - Create 20-30 review questions (STAAR format) on index cards or slides - Divide class into 3-4 “spacecraft crews” (teams) - Draw a simple space grid on the whiteboard (5x5) — some squares have asteroids (X), some are clear

**How to Play:** 1. Teams take turns answering questions 2. Correct answer = team moves one space forward on the grid 3. If they land on an asteroid, they lose a turn (but stay in place) 4. If they get a question wrong, they don’t move 5. First team to cross the grid “escapes the asteroid field”

**Bonus:** Add “wormhole” squares that jump the team ahead 2 spaces, and “black hole” squares that send them back 1.

**Materials:** Index cards or slides with questions, whiteboard, markers, magnets or sticky notes for team markers

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## 2. Warp Speed Challenge (Fast-Paced Whole Class)

**Type:** Individual competitive | **Time:** 15-20 min | **Best for:** Quick fact review, computation, vocabulary

**Setup:** - Project questions one at a time (5-10 second timer per question) - Students write answers on whiteboards

**How to Play:** 1. Display question + start timer 2. Students write answer and hold up whiteboard when timer ends 3. Correct answers earn 1 point (students track their own score) 4. Every 5 questions, announce who's in "warp speed" (5/5 correct) 5. Final score: students who got 80%+ earn a "Warp Speed Badge"

**Twist:** Include 2-3 "Hyperdrive" questions worth double points (harder questions).

**Materials:** Projector/slides, whiteboards, markers, timer

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## 3. Escape the Space Station (Escape Room Style)

**Type:** Small group (3-4 students) | **Time:** 30-40 min | **Best for:** Mixed subject review

**Setup:** - Create 5 "locks" (envelopes or folders) each containing a puzzle/question set - Each lock has 4-5 STAAR-format questions - Correct answers reveal a code (e.g., the answer to #3 is "B" — B=2, so the code digit is 2) - Final code opens the "airlock" (a sealed envelope with a prize or certificate inside)

**How to Play:** 1. Groups start at Lock 1 2. Solve all questions correctly to get the code for that lock 3. Bring code to teacher to verify, then get Lock 2 4. First group to crack all 5 codes and open the airlock wins 5. All groups that finish within the time limit earn "Escape Specialist" badges

**Materials:** 5 envelopes per group (labeled Lock 1–5), question sets, code answer key, "airlock" prize envelope, timer

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## INDIVIDUAL ACTIVITIES

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### 4. Mission Log Journal (Daily Writing)

**Type:** Individual | **Time:** 10-15 min | **Best for:** ELA/writing practice + metacognition

**Instructions:** Each day, students write a “Mission Log” entry in their journal (a folded piece of paper or composition book). Prompts: - **Monday:** “Mission Log Day 1: Today I learned/reviewed... The skill I need to work on most is... because...” - **Tuesday:** “Mission Log Day 2: My biggest math challenge is... Here’s how I plan to tackle it...” - **Wednesday:** “Mission Log Day 3: Something that surprised me in science/social studies review was...” - **Thursday:** “Mission Log Day 4: During today’s simulation, I felt... My strategy for tough questions is...” - **Friday:** “Mission Log Day 5: I am ready for STAAR because... My advice to a nervous cadet would be...”

**Materials:** Paper or journals, pencils

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### 5. Star Map Concept Organizer (Individual Study Tool)

**Type:** Individual | **Time:** 20 min | **Best for:** Organizing knowledge in any subject

**Instructions:** Students draw a large star with 5 points on a piece of paper. In the center: the subject name. On each point of the star, they write one major concept/topic. Along each line between points, they write connections between concepts. This creates a visual “star map” of their knowledge.

**Example (5th Grade Science):** - Center: “Science” - Points: Matter & Energy, Force & Motion, Earth & Space, Organisms, Ecosystems - Lines: “Energy can change forms of matter” (between Matter & Force), “Organisms depend on ecosystems” (between Organisms & Ecosystems)

**Materials:** Large paper (11x17 or butcher paper), colored markers

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### 6. Cadet Training Flashcards (Self-Study)

**Type:** Individual | **Time:** 15-20 min to create, then used throughout the week | **Best for:** Vocabulary, key facts, formulas

**Instructions:** Students create themed flashcards: - Front: Term/concept with a small space-themed doodle - Back: Definition, example, and a memory trick - Cards are stored in a “Mission Pouch” (ziplock bag decorated with stars) - Students quiz themselves for 5 minutes at the start of each Training Block

**Materials:** Index cards, markers, ziplock bags, star stickers

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## PARTNER ACTIVITIES

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### 7. Co-Pilot Quiz (Partner Quiz)

**Type:** Partner | **Time:** 20 min | **Best for:** Any subject review

**Instructions:** 1. Each student writes 5 STAAR-style questions based on the day’s topic (with answer key) 2. Partners swap questions 3. Each partner completes the other’s quiz 4. Partners grade each other and discuss any disagreements 5. “Co-Pilot Rating”: Both partners must agree on all answers — if they disagree, they must find evidence to resolve it

**Materials:** Paper, pencils, textbook/notes for reference

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### 8. Mission Control & Pilot (Problem Solving Pairs)

**Type:** Partner | **Time:** 20-25 min | **Best for:** Math problem solving, multi-step questions

**Instructions:** - Partner A = Pilot (solves the problem, thinking aloud) - Partner B = Mission Control (listens, asks questions, checks work — but does NOT solve) - Mission Control can say: “Check your calculation,” “What’s the question asking?,” “Can you explain that step?” - After 2-3 problems, switch roles

**Why it works:** Forces students to articulate their thinking. Mission Control catches errors the Pilot misses.

**Materials:** Problem set (6-8 multi-step problems), pencils, scratch paper

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## GROUP ACTIVITIES

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### 9. Planetary Stations (Rotation Activity)

**Type:** Groups of 4-5 | **Time:** 30-40 min | **Best for:** Multi-topic review

**Setup:** Set up 4-5 stations around the room, each labeled as a planet: - **Mercury** — Quick computation/grammar (fast and close to the sun) - **Mars** — Reading comprehension (the red planet = read!) - **Jupiter** — Word problems (the biggest challenges) - **Saturn** — Vocabulary/key terms (rings = connections) - **Neptune** — Science/social studies (the far reaches)

**How to Play:** 1. Groups rotate every 6-8 minutes 2. At each planet, complete the task and record answers on a “Flight Log” sheet 3. Groups that complete all planets correctly earn “Galaxy Explorer” status

**Materials:** Station question sets, Flight Log recording sheets, timer, planet labels for stations

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### 10. Intergalactic Debate (Structured Discussion)

**Type:** Groups of 4 | **Time:** 20 min | **Best for:** Reading/ELA, Social Studies, constructed response practice

**Instructions:** 1. Present a STAAR-style question with two plausible answer choices 2. Within each group, 2 students argue for Choice A, 2 for Choice B 3. Each side has 2 minutes to present their evidence (from the text/source) 4. After both sides present, the group votes on the correct answer 5. Teacher reveals the correct answer and discusses why

**Example:** “Which sentence BEST describes the author’s purpose?” — show two reasonable options. Students must use textual evidence to argue their case.

**Materials:** Debate question prompts (3-4 per session), passages/sources, timer

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### 11. Space Station Build (Collaborative Study Guide)

**Type:** Groups of 3-4 | **Time:** 25-30 min | **Best for:** End-of-topic synthesis

**Instructions:** Each group is assigned a “section” of the space station to build (a piece of butcher paper). Their section covers one major topic/reporting category. Groups must include: - 5 key vocabulary words with definitions - 3 example problems/questions with solutions - 2 test-taking tips specific to that topic - 1 visual/diagram

Completed sections are posted on the wall to form a complete “space station” that serves as a class study guide.

**Materials:** Butcher paper or poster board, markers, textbooks/notes for reference, tape

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12. Alien Transmission Decoder (Problem Relay)

**Type:** Teams of 4-5 | **Time:** 15-20 min | **Best for:** Math computation, grammar/mechanics

**Instructions:** 1. Each team lines up facing the board 2. First person runs to the board, grabs a question from the “transmission” (envelope), solves it, writes the answer 3. Runs back and tags next teammate 4. Next teammate grabs question 2 and solves it 5. Continue until all questions are answered 6. First team to correctly decode all transmissions wins

**Catch:** If any answer is wrong, the whole transmission is “garbled” — team must find and fix the error before it counts.

**Materials:** Envelopes with individual question slips (5-6 per team), answer recording sheets, markers

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 **Activity Planning Matrix**

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| Activity            | Day        | Duration  | Type       | Subject     |
|---------------------|------------|-----------|------------|-------------|
| Mission Log Journal | Daily      | 10-15 min | Individual | ELA/Writing |
| Star Map Organizer  | Mon or Wed | 20 min    | Individual | Any         |

| Activity                      | Day                                | Duration                 | Type              | Subject      |
|-------------------------------|------------------------------------|--------------------------|-------------------|--------------|
| Cadet Flashcards              | Mon<br>(create),<br>daily<br>(use) | 15-20 min + 5<br>min/day | Individual        | Any          |
| Co-Pilot Quiz                 | Tue or<br>Thu                      | 20 min                   | Partner           | Any          |
| Mission Control &<br>Pilot    | Tue                                | 20-25 min                | Partner           | Math         |
| Asteroid Field                | Wed                                | 20-25 min                | Group<br>game     | Any          |
| Warp Speed<br>Challenge       | Fri                                | 15-20 min                | Class game        | Any          |
| Escape the Space<br>Station   | Thu or<br>Fri                      | 30-40 min                | Group<br>game     | Mixed        |
| Planetary Stations            | Wed                                | 30-40 min                | Group<br>rotation | Mixed        |
| Intergalactic Debate          | Mon or<br>Thu                      | 20 min                   | Group             | ELA/SS       |
| Space Station Build           | Wed or<br>Thu                      | 25-30 min                | Group<br>project  | Any          |
| Alien Transmission<br>Decoder | Tue or<br>Fri                      | 15-20 min                | Team relay        | Math/Grammar |

*Choose the activities that fit your schedule and students. You don't have to use all 12 — pick your favorites and make them legendary. 🚀*

## ★ STAAR Wars — Student Materials

*Every student-facing material you need for the week, described in detail. Print, cut, and go.*

## Daily Materials Overview

| Day       | Handouts                                                               | Rewards                                        |
|-----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Monday    | Cadet ID Badge, Mission 1 Packet, Mission Log page, Star Map organizer | Mission 1 Badge                                |
| Tuesday   | Mission 2 Packet, Mission Log page, Flashcard supplies                 | Mission 2 Badge                                |
| Wednesday | Mission 3 Packet, Mission Log page, Station Flight Log                 | Mission 3 Badge + midweek treat                |
| Thursday  | Re-Entry Simulation Test, Mission Log page, Self-Assessment sheet      | Mission 4 Badge                                |
| Friday    | Mission 5 Strategy Sheet, Letter-to-Myself paper, Cadet Yearbook page  | Mission 5 Badge + Mission Complete Certificate |

## Cadet ID Badge

**Description:** A credential card each student receives on Monday morning. Makes them feel “official.”

**Design:** - Size: 3” x 4” (print 4 per page on cardstock) - Header: “STAAR COMMAND” with small star graphics - Fields: - **CADET:** [Student Name] - **CREW:** [Table Group — Alpha, Bravo, Charlie, Delta] - **RANK:** STAAR Trainee (can be “upgraded” to STAAR Ready on Friday) - **CLEARANCE:** Level 5 - Small box for student to draw their face or attach a photo - Bottom: “This cadet is authorized for all STAAR missions”



**How to use:** Hand out Monday. Students keep on their desk or in a badge holder (lanyard optional). On Friday, stamp or write “STAAR READY” across it as a final upgrade.



## Daily Mission Packets

**Description:** Each day’s review content, themed as a mission briefing.

**Format for each packet:** - **Cover page:** “MISSION [#]: [Mission Name] — CLASSIFIED” - Date, Cadet name line, Crew assignment - “Objective:” one-sentence description of the day’s focus - “Difficulty Level: ★★☆☆☆” (adjust per day) - **Content pages:** STAAR-format questions (teacher provides the actual questions — use released STAAR tests or your own) - Reading: passage + multiple choice + open-ended - Math: multiple choice + griddable + word problems - Science/SS: multiple choice + short answer - **Back page:** “Mission Debrief” — 3 reflection questions: 1. “What strategy helped me most today?” 2. “What type of question was hardest?” 3. “What will I focus on tomorrow?”

**Teacher note:** You provide the actual STAAR-format content. We provide the themed framework/cover pages. Use released STAAR tests from TEA ([tea.texas.gov](http://tea.texas.gov)) or your own review materials.



## Mission Log (Daily Journal)

**Description:** A simple journal page for daily reflection. Can be printed as individual sheets or compiled into a booklet.

**Design (per page):** - Header: “SPACE LOG — Day [#] — [Date]” - Decorative border with small stars - **Prompt:** (Changes daily — see LESSON-PLANS.md for prompts) - 12-15 lined writing spaces - Footer: “Cadet signature: \_\_\_\_\_”

**Booklet option:** Print 5 pages (Mon–Fri), staple together with a cover page: “Mission Log — Cadet [Name] — STAAR Command, [Year]”



## Mission Badge System

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**The system:** Students earn one badge per day for completing their mission packet and participating. By Friday, a full badge card = 5 badges = “Mission Complete.”

### Badge Card

- Size: 5” x 7” (print 2 per page)
- Title: “MISSION BADGE TRACKER”
- 5 circular spaces arranged like a constellation (connect with dotted lines)
- Each circle labeled: Mission 1, Mission 2, Mission 3, Mission 4, Mission 5
- Center text: “Complete all 5 missions to earn LAUNCH CLEARANCE”
- Space at top for student name

### How badges work:

- **Option A (cheapest):** Teacher stamps each circle with a star stamp or draws a star
- **Option B:** Teacher places a star sticker in each circle
- **Option C (fanciest):** Print small circular badge stickers that students peel and place themselves

### Badge Criteria:

- Completed the daily packet (doesn’t need to be 100% correct — effort counts)
- Participated in the day’s activities
- Showed good “cadet behavior” (respectful, on task)

**Tip:** Be generous. The badge system is about MOTIVATION, not gatekeeping. If a student tried, they earn their badge.

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## Launch Sequence Countdown Poster

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**Description:** A large classroom poster that counts down from 5 to 1 (liftoff!). Updated daily.

**Design:** - Title: “LAUNCH SEQUENCE” - Large numbers: 5 — 4 — 3 — 2 — 1 —   
 LAUNCH! - Each number has a checkbox or space for a large X/check - Each number labeled with the day: “5 = Monday,” “4 = Tuesday,” etc. - Rocket graphic at the bottom, “launching” upward toward the numbers - At the top: “STAAR TEST = LIFTOFF”

**How to use:** Each afternoon during debrief, dramatically check off the day. Students count down together. By Friday: “3... 2... 1... LIFTOFF!”



## Mission Complete Certificate

**Description:** End-of-week certificate awarded Friday afternoon. Make it a moment — call each student up individually.

**Design:** - Size: 8.5” x 11” (landscape) - Header: Large star graphic + “STAAR COMMAND” - Title: “MISSION COMPLETE CERTIFICATE” - Body: “This certifies that **Cadet [Name]** has successfully completed all five missions at STAAR Command and is cleared for STAAR launch. This cadet has demonstrated courage, skill, and determination. The galaxy is proud.” - Signature lines: “Mission Commander: \_\_\_\_\_” and “Date: \_\_\_\_\_” - Footer: rocket ship graphic, stars, official-looking border - Optional: gold/silver foil sticker seal



## Bonus Transmission (Early Finisher Activity)

**Description:** For students who finish their daily packet early. A challenge extension.

**Design:** - Header: “INCOMING TRANSMISSION — CLASSIFIED — FOR ADVANCED CADETS ONLY” - Contains 2-3 harder questions or a more complex passage/problem - Or: a creative prompt (“Write a log entry from the perspective of a STAAR question that nobody ever gets right. What would it say?”) - Fun, optional, but gives early finishers something engaging



## Cadet Yearbook Page (Friday Activity)

**Description:** Fun end-of-week activity where students sign each other's pages. Memory keepsake.

**Design:** - Title: "STAAR Command Yearbook — Class of [Year]" - "My Crew:" lines for 4-5 names - "My Commander (Teacher):" line - "My Favorite Mission Was:" short answer line - "On STAAR Day, I Will:" short answer line - "Autographs:" Large open space for classmates to sign and write short messages - Small space: "Draw yourself as an astronaut"

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## Self-Assessment Sheet (Thursday)

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**Description:** After the Re-Entry Simulation, students identify their strengths and areas to review.

**Design:** - Title: "POST-SIMULATION ANALYSIS" - Section 1: "Questions I got RIGHT — what strategy worked?" - Space for 3-4 entries - Section 2: "Questions I got WRONG — what went wrong?" - Space for 3-4 entries with columns: "Question Topic | What confused me | What I'll do differently" - Section 3: "My Top 3 Focus Areas for STAAR Day" - Numbered 1-3 - Section 4: "My confidence level: ☆☆☆☆☆" (circle 1-5 stars)

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## Letter to Myself (Friday)

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**Description:** Students write a brief letter to themselves, sealed in an envelope. Teacher hands them back on actual STAAR test day as a confidence boost.

**Provided template:** - "Dear Future Me," - "This week I learned..." - "The strategy I'll use most on STAAR day is..." - "I'm proud of myself because..." - "Remember:..." - "You've got this! — [Name]"

Students seal it in an envelope. Teacher writes student name on outside, collects, and stores until test day.

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## Printing Summary

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| Material                         | Pages per Student | Total for 25 Students       |
|----------------------------------|-------------------|-----------------------------|
| Cadet ID Badge                   | 0.25 (4/page)     | 7 pages                     |
| Mission Packets (5 days)         | ~3-5 per day      | 75-125 pages                |
| Mission Log (5 days)             | 5 (or 1 booklet)  | 125 pages (or 30 booklets)  |
| Badge Card                       | 0.5 (2/page)      | 13 pages                    |
| Certificate                      | 1                 | 25 pages                    |
| Bonus Transmissions (5)          | 1 each            | 5 pages                     |
| Yearbook Page                    | 1                 | 25 pages                    |
| Self-Assessment                  | 1                 | 25 pages                    |
| Letter Template                  | 1                 | 25 pages                    |
| <b>TOTAL (excluding packets)</b> |                   | <b>~250 pages + packets</b> |

**Tip:** Print badge cards and certificates on cardstock. Everything else on regular paper is fine. Print mission packets double-sided to save paper.

*Every material here is designed to make students feel like this week is SPECIAL — not just another review session. 🚀*

## ★ STAAR Wars — Decoration Guide

*Transform your hallway into a space station and your classroom into STAAR Command Center.*



### Setup Timeline

| When                           | What                                                     |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>2 weeks before</b>          | Order/buy supplies, recruit helpers                      |
| <b>1 week before</b>           | Start cutting, assembling pieces at home or after school |
| <b>Friday before boot camp</b> | Set up hallway decorations (2-3 hours with help)         |
| <b>Sunday/Monday morning</b>   | Final classroom setup (1 hour)                           |

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## HALLWAY TRANSFORMATION: Space Station Corridor

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### The Vision

Students walk down the hallway and feel like they're inside a space station. Black walls, twinkling lights, planet labels on classroom doors, a mission control banner overhead.

### Step-by-Step Instructions

#### 1. Black Out the Walls

- Cover bulletin boards and wall space with **black butcher paper** or **black plastic tablecloths** (dollar store)
- Doesn't need to be floor-to-ceiling — waist-height to above door frames is plenty
- Tape securely with painter's tape (won't damage walls)
- **Cost:** ~\$8-12 for butcher paper roll, or ~\$6 for 3-4 plastic tablecloths

#### 2. Stars & Galaxies

- Cut small stars from **white and silver cardstock** or use **metallic star stickers**
- Scatter across the black background — random clusters look more realistic
- Optional: Add a few **glow-in-the-dark stars** (dollar store packs)
- For galaxies: crumple white tissue paper into loose spirals and tape flat against the black

- **Cost:** ~\$3-5 for stickers/cardstock

### 3. Twinkle Lights (Optional but AMAZING)

- String **white fairy lights** (battery-operated) along the top edge of the black paper
- Dollar Tree and Walmart carry battery-operated string lights for \$1-5
- Secure with clear tape or command strips
- **Cost:** ~\$3-10 for 2-3 strings

### 4. Planet Door Signs

- Each classroom door gets a **planet label** (printable — see below)
- Planet name + teacher name + subject: “Planet Rodriguez — Mathematics Division”
- Print on colored cardstock, laminate if possible, tape to doors
- **Cost:** ~\$2 for cardstock (print at school)

### 5. Main Entrance Banner

- Large banner across the hallway entrance: “**WELCOME TO STAAR COMMAND — AUTHORIZED CADETS ONLY**”
- Use a roll of butcher paper (white or black) and paint/marker the letters
- Or print individual letters on 8.5x11 paper and tape together
- Add silver/gold accents
- **Cost:** ~\$0-3 (use existing supplies)

### 6. Floor Details (Optional)

- Use painter’s tape to create “runway” lines on the floor leading to classrooms
- Or tape down paper “footprints” (boot prints) leading the way
- Label: “Follow the path to your mission station”
- **Cost:** ~\$3-5 for painter’s tape

### Hallway Materials List & Budget

| Item                                    | Quantity                | Source                      | Est. Cost      |
|-----------------------------------------|-------------------------|-----------------------------|----------------|
| Black butcher paper (or tablecloths)    | 1 roll or 4 tablecloths | School supply / Dollar Tree | \$6-12         |
| White/silver star stickers or cardstock | 2-3 packs               | Dollar Tree / Walmart       | \$3-5          |
| Battery-operated fairy lights           | 2-3 strings             | Dollar Tree / Walmart       | \$3-10         |
| Colored cardstock (for planet signs)    | 10-15 sheets            | School supply room          | \$0-3          |
| Painter's tape                          | 2 rolls                 | Walmart / Dollar Tree       | \$3-5          |
| Butcher paper for banner (white)        | 1 section               | School supply               | \$0            |
| Markers/paint for banner                | Use existing            | —                           | \$0            |
| <b>TOTAL</b>                            |                         |                             | <b>\$15-35</b> |

### Budget-Friendly Alternatives

- **Skip fairy lights** — stars on black paper still looks great
- **Use newspaper** painted black instead of butcher paper
- **Have students make stars** as an art activity the week before — free labor + they feel ownership
- **Borrow from other teachers** — someone has leftover butcher paper and fairy lights





## CLASSROOM SETUP: STAAR Command Center

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### The Vision

Students walk into a command center. The door has an official-looking sign. Inside, desks are arranged in “mission formation,” walls have space-themed motivational posters, and there’s a Mission Progress board.

### Door Sign

- **“STAAR COMMAND CENTER — AUTHORIZED PERSONNEL ONLY”**
- Print on 11x17 (or tape two 8.5x11 together)
- Black background, white/silver text, add a star or rocket graphic
- Laminate for durability

### Desk Name Tags

- **“Cadet [Student Name]”** in a space-themed design
- Print on cardstock, fold into tent-style name tags
- Include the student’s “crew” (table group) name: Alpha Crew, Bravo Crew, etc.

### Wall Decorations

#### Mission Progress Board

- Large poster or section of butcher paper
- Title: **“MISSION PROGRESS — LAUNCH SEQUENCE”**
- 5 columns (Mon–Fri), each labeled Mission 1–5
- Student names listed; add a star sticker next to their name for each completed mission
- By Friday, students with 5 stars are “Launch Ready”

#### Space Log Strategy Wall

- Dedicate a section of wall/board to **“Space Log Entries”**
- Each day, add the day’s key strategy (written on a star cutout or strip of paper)

- By Friday, you have 5 strategies posted — a visual study guide

## Motivational Posters

Print and display: - “The sky is NOT the limit — you’re going to STAAR and beyond!” - “Failure is not an option.” — NASA Mission Control (adapted) - “Every expert was once a beginner cadet.” - “Houston, we DON’T have a problem — because we PREPARED.”

## Room Arrangement Tips

- If possible, arrange desks in clusters (4-5 desks = a “crew station”)
- Label each cluster: Alpha Crew, Bravo Crew, Charlie Crew, Delta Crew
- Teacher desk = “Mission Commander’s Console”
- If you have a reading corner: rename it “The Observatory”

## Classroom Materials List

| Item                               | Quantity       | Source                        | Est. Cost |
|------------------------------------|----------------|-------------------------------|-----------|
| Door sign (printed)                | 1              | School printer                | \$0       |
| Desk name tags (printed)           | 1 per student  | School printer / cardstock    | \$0-2     |
| Mission Progress poster            | 1 large poster | Butcher paper or poster board | \$0-2     |
| Star stickers (for progress board) | 1-2 packs      | Dollar Tree                   | \$1-2     |
| Motivational posters (printed)     | 4-6            | School printer                | \$0       |
| Space Log strategy                 | 5              | Cardstock + marker            | \$0       |

| Item               | Quantity | Source                 | Est. Cost    |
|--------------------|----------|------------------------|--------------|
| strips             |          |                        |              |
| Table group labels | 4-6      | Printed or handwritten | \$0          |
| <b>TOTAL</b>       |          |                        | <b>\$1-6</b> |



## Printable Elements Needed

*These describe what should be designed and printed. Create actual printables as a separate step.*

| Printable                          | Description                                                                                                                                | Size                               | Qty           |
|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|---------------|
| <b>Door Sign</b>                   | “STAAR Command Center — Authorized Personnel Only” with rocket/star graphics. Black background, white/silver text. Official/military look. | 11x17 or 2x 8.5x11                 | 1             |
| <b>Planet Door Signs</b>           | One per classroom. Planet illustration + “Planet [Teacher Name] — [Subject]”                                                               | 8.5x11                             | 6-8           |
| <b>Main Hallway Banner Letters</b> | Individual letters spelling “WELCOME TO STAAR COMMAND” — silver/white on black, or print as one long banner                                | 8.5x11 per letter or banner format | 1 set         |
| <b>Cadet ID Badges</b>             | Name tag style. “STAAR Command — Cadet [Name] — Crew: [X] — Clearance Level: STAAR Ready” with space for photo or drawing                  | 3x4 inches (4 per page)            | 1 per student |

| Printable                           | Description                                                                                                                                                      | Size                            | Qty                 |
|-------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|---------------------|
| <b>Desk Name Tags</b>               | Tent-fold. "Cadet [Name]" with stars and rocket                                                                                                                  | 10x3 inches<br>(3 per page)     | 1 per student       |
| <b>Mission Progress Poster</b>      | Large grid: 5 columns (Mission 1-5), rows for student names, space for star stickers                                                                             | 24x36 or butcher paper          | 1                   |
| <b>Launch Sequence Countdown</b>    | Poster showing 5-4-3-2-1 countdown. Each number = a day. Space to check off each day.                                                                            | 18x24                           | 1                   |
| <b>Mission Badges</b>               | Small circular badges (like merit badges). 5 designs: Mission 1-5. Space for sticker/stamp.                                                                      | 2 inch circles<br>(12 per page) | 1 sheet per student |
| <b>Mission Complete Certificate</b> | "This certifies that Cadet [Name] has successfully completed all missions at STAAR Command and is cleared for launch."<br>Rocket graphics, stars, official look. | 8.5x11                          | 1 per student       |
| <b>Motivational Posters</b>         | 4-6 space-themed quotes (see list above) with graphics                                                                                                           | 8.5x11                          | 4-6                 |
| <b>Star Cutouts</b>                 | Various sizes for wall decoration. Silver/white.                                                                                                                 | 3-6 inches                      | 30-50               |
| <b>Cadet Yearbook Page</b>          | Fun page for Friday: "My crew," space for friends to sign, "My favorite mission was...", "On STAAR day I will..."                                                | 8.5x11                          | 1 per student       |



## Total Budget Estimate

| Area         | Low End              | High End                   |
|--------------|----------------------|----------------------------|
| Hallway      | \$15                 | \$35                       |
| Classroom    | \$1                  | \$6                        |
| Printing     | \$0 (school printer) | \$10 (if buying ink/paper) |
| <b>TOTAL</b> | <b>\$16</b>          | <b>\$51</b>                |

### Dollar Store Shopping List (One Trip)

- ☐ Black plastic tablecloths x4 (\$4)
- ☐ Star stickers x2 packs (\$2)
- ☐ Battery fairy lights x2 (\$2)
- ☐ Poster board x2 (\$2)
- ☐ Cardstock pack (\$1)
- ☐ Painter's tape (\$1)
- **Dollar Store Total: ~\$12**

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### Who Can Help?

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- **Student helpers** — Set up stars, cut out shapes, decorate (the Friday before, or a class period)
  - **Parent volunteers** — Hallway transformation goes 3x faster with 2-3 adults
  - **Grade-level team** — Split the hallway work. Each teacher decorates their own door; share hallway duties
  - **Art teacher** — May have butcher paper, supplies, and willing student artists
  - **Custodial staff** — Give them a heads up! Ask about any restrictions on taping things to walls
- 

*Remember: imperfect decorations done with enthusiasm beat perfect decorations that stress you out. The kids will love it either way. ★*

# ★ STAAR Wars — Parent Letter

*Copy, customize, and send home the week before boot camp. Available in English and Spanish.*

## English Version

[School Letterhead / Teacher Name]

[Date]

Dear Families,

Next week, our classroom is transforming into **STAAR Command** for an exciting, space-themed STAAR prep week we're calling **"STAAR Wars Boot Camp!"** 🚀

**What is STAAR Boot Camp?** It's a fun, focused review week designed to help your child feel confident and prepared for the upcoming STAAR test. Instead of regular review worksheets, we've created an immersive experience where students become "cadets" completing daily "missions" that review key skills in [Reading/Math/Science/Social Studies].

**When:** [Monday, Date] – [Friday, Date]

**What to expect:** - 🌟 Your child will earn daily "Mission Badges" for completing review activities - 🌟 Our classroom and hallway will be decorated like a space station — ask your child about it! - 🌟 Students will practice with STAAR-format questions every day - 🌟 Friday, we'll celebrate with a "Mission Complete" certificate ceremony - 🌟 The focus is on building confidence AND reviewing skills

**How you can help at home:** 1. **Encourage a good night's sleep** — cadets need rest to perform their best 2. **Ask about their missions** — "What mission did you complete today?" keeps the excitement going 3. **Review flashcards** — your child may bring home

study cards; 5-10 minutes of review at home helps 4. **Stay positive** — remind your child that STAAR is just one way to show what they’ve learned. They’ve been preparing all year! 5. **Healthy breakfast** — especially during test week, a good breakfast fuels the brain

**On actual STAAR test day ([date]):** - Please ensure your child arrives on time and well-rested - A healthy breakfast makes a big difference - Encourage them: “You’ve trained for this. You’re ready!”

I’m excited about this week and confident it will help your child feel prepared. If you have any questions, please don’t hesitate to reach out.

Let’s launch into success! 🚀

Sincerely, **[Teacher Name]** [Email] | [Phone/Remind/Class Dojo info]

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## Spanish Version (Versión en Español)

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**[Membrete de la escuela / Nombre del maestro(a)]**

**[Fecha]**

Estimadas familias,

La próxima semana, nuestro salón de clases se transformará en el **Centro de Comando STAAR** para una emocionante semana de preparación temática espacial que llamamos “**¡STAAR Wars Boot Camp!**” 🚀

**¿Qué es el STAAR Boot Camp?** Es una semana de repaso divertida y enfocada, diseñada para ayudar a su hijo(a) a sentirse seguro(a) y preparado(a) para el próximo examen STAAR. En lugar de hojas de repaso regulares, hemos creado una experiencia inmersiva donde los estudiantes se convierten en “cadetes” que completan “misiones” diarias que repasan habilidades clave en [Lectura/Matemáticas/Ciencias/Estudios Sociales].

**Cuándo:** [Lunes, fecha] – [Viernes, fecha]

**Qué esperar:** - 🌟 Su hijo(a) ganará “Insignias de Misión” diarias por completar actividades de repaso - 🌟 Nuestro salón y pasillo estarán decorados como una estación espacial — ¡pregúntele a su hijo(a)! - 🌟 Los estudiantes practicarán con preguntas en formato STAAR todos los días - 🌟 El viernes, celebraremos con una ceremonia de certificados de “Misión Completa” - 🌟 El enfoque es desarrollar confianza Y repasar habilidades

**Cómo pueden ayudar en casa:** 1. **Fomenten un buen descanso** — los cadetes necesitan dormir bien para dar lo mejor de sí 2. **Pregunten sobre sus misiones** — “¿Qué misión completaste hoy?” mantiene la emoción 3. **Repasen las tarjetas de estudio** — su hijo(a) puede traer tarjetas a casa; 5-10 minutos de repaso ayudan 4. **Manténganse positivos** — recuérdense a su hijo(a) que el STAAR es solo una forma de demostrar lo que han aprendido. ¡Se han preparado todo el año! 5. **Desayuno saludable** — especialmente durante la semana del examen, un buen desayuno alimenta el cerebro

**El día del examen STAAR ([fecha]):** - Por favor asegúrese de que su hijo(a) llegue a tiempo y bien descansado(a) - Un desayuno saludable hace una gran diferencia - Anímelos: “¡Entrenaste para esto. Estás listo(a)!”

Estoy emocionado(a) por esta semana y confío en que ayudará a su hijo(a) a sentirse preparado(a). Si tienen alguna pregunta, no duden en comunicarse.

¡Despeguemos hacia el éxito! 🚀

Atentamente, **[Nombre del maestro(a)]** [Correo electrónico] |  
[Teléfono/Remind/Class Dojo]

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*Customize brackets [ ] with your specific information before sending.*